

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: **PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions
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Our Theme: **CATCH - TAKE US THE FOXES.**



Song 2:15 Take us the foxes, the little foxes, that **SPOIL** the vines: for our vines have tender grapes. KJV

Song of Solomon 2:15 "... Take for us the foxes, the little foxes that **SPOIL** THE VINEYARDS [OF OUR LOVE], for our vineyards are in blossom. AMP

Song of Solomon 2:15 Catch all the foxes, those little foxes, before they **RUIN** THE VINEYARD OF LOVE, for the grapevines are blossoming! NLT

Song of Solomon 2:15 Catch for us the foxes, the little foxes that **RUIN** the vineyards, our vineyards that are in bloom. NIV

THE DEFINITION

■ "THE VINEYARD OF LOVE"

■ IT'S ABOUT THE WOMEN'S LOVE FOR HER BRIDEGROOM LOVER AND HIS LOVE FOR HER.

THE MESSAGE

■ THE LITTLE FOXES SEEK TO RUIN "THE VINEYARD OF LOVE"

- THE VINEYARD AND ITS FRUIT IS A TYPE OF OUR LIVES AND OF THE LOVE THAT WE HAVE FOR CHRIST, THE ONE WHO FIRST LOVED US.
- THESE LITTLE FOXES SEEK TO RUIN / SPOIL / DAMAGE THAT LOVE BY ATTACKING ITS FRUIT, THE TENDER GRAPES.
- They are described as tender because they are vulnerable and needing protection.
- THESE FOXES ARE OUR ADVERSARIES / ENEMIES THAT SEEK TO MAR AND SPOIL THE FRUIT OF THAT LOVE THAT WE POSSESS FOR CHRIST, OUR BRIDEGROOM.

THE WARNING

■ THESE LITTLE FOXES SEEK TO SERIOUSLY DAMAGE OUR LOVE AND AFFECTION FOR CHRIST (OUR BRIDEGROOM) BY USING LITTLE THINGS LIKE POOR ATTITUDES, PREJUDICES, DISPLEASURE AND DISSATISFACTION ETC.

- According to the John's gospel chapter 15 we are JOINED (united) to the true vine which is Christ; and that union is A UNION OF LOVE.
- And it is the branches that produce the fruit from SUCH A UNION, the result of he first loving us.
- This is a LASTING UNION OF LOVE established by God with the believer through the new birth and WILL NOT PASS AWAY even if we fail to perform as we should.

THE CENTRAL FACTOR FOR US:

■ IS OUR LOVE AND AFFECTION FOR CHRIST AND MAKING SURE THAT WE GUARD AND PROTECT OURSELVES from allowing little things (like wrong attitudes, prejudices, complaining, dissatisfaction etc.) to come into OUR LIVES.

- Because such things tend to WEAKEN or AFFECT OUR LOVE FOR CHRIST AND THE BEAUTIFUL JOY THAT WE EXPERIENCE FROM LOVING HIM.

OUR MANDATE:

■ IS FOR US TO CONTINUALLY REMAIN IN HIS LOVE WITH EVER INCREASING VIGOUR (LOVING HIM MORE AND MORE).

- That will take vigilance and effort on our part; BECAUSE:

THE DANGER IS REAL

IT NOT SO MUCH THAT THE LITTLE FOXES SEEK TO DESTROY THE TENDER GRAPE, BUT MORE TO DAMAGE THE FRUIT OF THE VINE SO THAT IT BEARS THE SCARS OR MARK OF THEIR ACTIVITY IN ITS JOURNEY TO MATURITY.

REMEMBER:

- It is the little leaven that spoils the whole lump. **1 Corinthians 5:6 & Galatians 5:9.**
- It is the little flies that spoil the ointment of the chemist. **Ecclesiastes 10:11**
- It's a little foolishness that spoils the reputation of a person who is known for wisdom and honor. **Ecclesiastes 10:11**
- It is also the little folding of the arms and the tendency to sleep (unwatchful) at an inappropriate time that brings poverty that is not easily removed. **Proverbs 6:10-11**

THE COMMAND:

■ IS FOR US TO NOT ONLY GUARD AGAINST BUT ALSO TO ACTUALLY CATCH, THOSE FOXES, TO TAKE THEM INTO CUSTODY AND DEPRIVE THEM OF THEIR ABILITY TO RUIN, DAMAGE, AND MAR THAT LOVE.

REMAIN / CONTINUE IN MY LOVE

John 15:9-10

9 "As the Father has loved me, so have I loved you. Now remain in my love.

10 If you obey my commands, you will remain in my love, just as I have obeyed my Father's commands and remain in his love. NIV

John 15:9 As the Father hath loved me, so have I loved you: continue ye in my love. KJV

GOD'S LOVE REMAINING IN US, ACTS & RESPONDS TO NEED

- God's Love in us that always responds to those in need

1 John 3:17 But whoever has the world's goods, and sees his brother in need, and closes his heart of compassion against him, how does the love of God remain in him? WEB

GUARD & KEEP YOURSELVES IN GOD'S LOVE

Jude 21 Guard and keep yourselves in the love of God; expect and patiently wait for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ (the Messiah) — [which will bring you] unto life eternal. AMP

FIRMLY ROOTED & ESTABLISHED IN LOVE

Ephesians 3:17 and that the Messiah may dwell in your hearts through faith. I pray that you, being rooted and firmly established in love, Holman Bible

WALK IN LOVE – LIVE A LIFE OF LOVE offering & sacrificing yourself to God.

Ephesians 5:2 live a life of love, just as Christ loved us and gave himself up for **us as a** fragrant offering and sacrifice to God. NIV

Ephesians 5:2 Walk in love, even as Christ also loved you, and gave himself up for us, **an offering** and **a sacrifice** to God for a sweet-smelling fragrance. WEB

GRACE ACCOMPANIES LOVING

Ephesians 6:24 May God's grace be eternally upon all who love our Lord Jesus Christ. NLT

GOD ACKNOWLEDGES, TAKES NOTICE OF THOSE WHO LOVE GOD.

1 Corinthians 8:3 But the person who loves God is the one whom God recognizes. NLT

THE FOXES NATURE EXPOSED.

NOTE: The **CUNNING SNEAKY** DECEPTIVE NATURE OF THE LITTLE FOXES in the natural world, and it is the same with those little things that the Devil seeks to throw at us to spoil **our love for Christ**.

- **OUR LOVE FOR CHRIST** IS THE FRUIT OF THAT LOVE UNION THAT WE HAVE WITH CHRIST AND IT IS THE FRUIT THAT THE DEVIL (little foxes) SEEKS TO SPOIL AND Demean.
- LOVING GOD IS AN INCREDIBLY BEAUTIFUL AND ENJOYABLE EXPERIENCE.
- Let us be alert and seek to neutralize the work of those little foxes **so that our love for Christ remains strong & increasing.**